

- Congratulations, you've completed your first step on the functional medicine journey. When I finished AFMCP, I felt like I had finally found a framework, a system, that could truly transform the health of my patients. What I didn't realize then was how deeply it would transform me, both personally and professionally. You're now a part of a global community dedicated to healing at the root level, guided by science, systems thinking, and a deep respect for the individuality and the spirituality of every person we serve. Welcome to our community.

- When I decided to start functional medicine training, I remember my colleague saying, "Oh, you're just gonna have all the chronic fatigue and fibromyalgia patients," or, "There's no evidence for that." And then I attended and I was completely overwhelmed. There were all of these new words that I didn't know, and these concepts that I had never been introduced to, and this literature that I had never seen before. And then there was the node and the matrix and the ATMs. And I was so confused, and I felt like a leopard trying to change her spots, but then I started applying what I had learned in practice, and the patients started getting better with just foundational changes to their lifestyle. And that's where the magic happens. The timeline would reveal the root cause, and you would start seeing the interconnectedness of the patients. And you really changed the way you viewed a patient's presentation. And that's where the excitement and the curiosity came back in. I really believe that functional medicine is the future of medicine. So welcome to the team.

- So my closing comment is that I hope you think of the matrix model as your thinking pad, those antecedents, triggers, and mediators, the clinical imbalances, the modifiable lifestyle factors, along with the timeline. That's where you're thinking and linking. And then you need to look at that and what are your points of leverage. What does that particular individual need more of, or what does that particular individual need less of? And then what do you think they can give up? What do you think they need to get? What is it that is going to allow them to start on that journey and get some noticeable difference in how they're feeling healing? That's what I hope you take away from this AFMCP. There's a lot of specifics, but in the big picture, it's thinking and linking and developing and assessing and taking advantage of those points of leverage that you find.

- Congratulations, you did it. When I first finished my AFMCP, my mind was swimming with information. So I have a couple of take-home messages for you. First of all, remember, that inflammation almost anywhere in the body probably starts with the gut, and you'll never be wrong starting there. Second, make it simple and make your message something that's easy for your patients to understand. We have a saying at our practice that you have to eat well, sleep well, move well, and poop well in order to be well. It just consolidates some of the things that we wanna do. So it's easier for patients to digest.

Good luck in your journey, can't wait to hear all about it.

- Congratulations, everybody, you made it through AFMCP. Probably right now, your brains are hurting, you are so full of information and so ready to get out there and let the healing begin. And I will share with you a piece of advice that I was given after I finished AFMCP a few years ago. Someone, a very wise mentor told me, you learned a lot of things and you're gonna want to incorporate everything into your practice tomorrow, but remember, that's almost impossible to do. So pick one thing that is in line with what brought you to functional medicine in the first place. Stick with that, know it really, really well, and then expand from there. For me, as a cardiologist, it just felt natural to manage cardiometabolic syndrome. That's what I started with. And now I've been able to expand into other avenues of functional medicine. So take a deep breath, this is an exciting ride. Focus and go and heal your patients.

- Do you believe in magic? You may not, but your patients do. And I want to give you three tips that you can use in your practice so that you can really deliver on your patient expectations. Many patients come in thinking that functional medicine is an opportunity for a miracle. It will somehow miraculously improve their health, relieve their symptoms, and give them the quality of life that potentially they may have been missing for a very long time. So here are the three Ps to your practice success. Number one, partnership. We talk a lot about therapeutic partnership, but partnership involves back and forth communication and setting expectations. Number two, participation. It isn't you doing the heavy lift for your patients, it's you doing work with your patients together collaboratively. This is a participatory process. And number three, power or empowerment. You need to empower your patients to make the therapeutic lifestyle changes so that you can deliver an opportunity for them to experience the magic of functional medicine.

- So one thing I want to impart to you is something that was revolutionary for me. A realization that, as a healing professional, you guys joined a healing profession, the ability to define healing and to understand what it is, how it happens, allows you to see what we're trying to achieve. I mean, when you're able to witness healing happen and make healing happen, then that's the win, that's the reason we joined this profession. Not biomarkers moving or patient satisfaction, although patient satisfaction will follow when you start to heal your patients. But healing happens when four things occur and they occur in sequence: A trusting and cooperative relationship is established; We achieve a shared understanding of what happened, why and what'll make it better; We agree on a ritual, "Hey, this is a thing that you're gonna do, I'm gonna do, we're gonna do together, or you do with these individuals over here," and we execute on that ritual; And then an improvement in the state of wellbeing. And that can be any domain: physical, mental, emotional, spiritual, social,

sexual, financial. You can have healing in those areas too. But the important thing is that when you see that you've established trust and rapport very quickly. When you got to a shared understanding of what's going on, why, what'll make it better, they're ready for the next thing. So that can help you choose which patients do I start with, Monday morning, where can I start trying to incorporate this with? Well, if you don't have a trusting cooperative relationship right off the bat, if you don't achieve a clear and shared understanding of what's the one thing I need to focus on right now, then maybe that's not the patient you wanna start trying to do functional medicine with. Those other patients where you do get to those two very quickly, that's low-hanging fruit, that's the opportunity to focus on the one thing, maybe the one handout, maybe the one piece of information that you know will change their biology. That's the person that you wanna start trying to do functional medicine with. So I was seeing 16 to 22 patients per day, very complex comorbid individuals, special operations, veteran community members. And I started seeing those people that were solution-oriented. We got trusting and shared understanding very quickly, and those were the people that I would say, "Hey, take this questionnaire, take this handout. I'm gonna schedule you for a series of appointments and we're gonna go ahead and try and do this different." So that's who to start with. Define healing, understand that. I hope that changes your practice 'cause it changed my world and changed my perspective.

- So my parting words for you are to share this quote by Mahatma Gandhi, which is the best way to find yourself is to lose yourself in the service of others. And that quote really has infused itself into my life before I even heard it or understood what it meant. Because when I first took AFMCP, I had this understanding, this knowing that this was the way to practice medicine and I was gonna dedicate my professional life to learning how to do it, to learning how to do it well, and ultimately to teaching others how to do it. And that became my purpose. I found myself committed to being in the service of others through caring for my patients in this new way. And so I fully jumped in and spent so much time and effort and energy to learn this medicine. And it was a joy. And that is how I found myself being lost in the service of learning, providing functional medicine, and teaching functional medicine, and then becoming a leader in this field. So thank you for allowing me to continue to find myself.

- Hi there. I would love to share with you what has really inspired my functional medicine journey. And that is watching my patients over the years looking for a provider that would listen, that would listen, that would tell their story back to them, that would ask questions and be fully, fully present in the therapeutic encounter. And when you provide that for your patients, that is therapeutic in itself. You've already ticked one of the boxes. Functional medicine is what patients want. They come to you because they wanna understand why they don't feel their best, They wanna understand what's driving that, and they

wanna fix it once and for all. And the tools that we've given you, the therapeutic diets, the understanding around the nervous system, the digestive system, all of the different things that you've learned in AFMCP are gonna really help you design a plan for your patients that gets 'em to that goal. And that goal is wellness, it's not perfect, but it is the best life that they can live and function in. And I think that you can start simply, it seems like of a lot of information, it seems very complicated, but ultimately listening is the first step. Don't underestimate the power of small things in this encounter. Don't underestimate the power of doing little things like encouraging someone to chew before their meals. And when in doubt, as we like to say in functional medicine, start with the gut, you're gonna do great. I'm rooting for you. Good luck.

- Hey, I'm Dr. David Haase, and I wanna tell you that I care about you as a clinician. I think that you're amazing. Anybody who is going to put themselves forward to learn something new so that you can do a better job of fulfilling your life calling of helping other people move down their path more beautifully, I give you honor. I wanna tell you something really important. You're enough. You know enough. Right now, you have life experience and backgrounds that have brought you to this place, and now you've gotten to sort of have some new information. And this is not the end. Functional medicine is the medicine of why. This is a medicine where we continually humble ourselves and go like, "Huh, why?" And continue to be ever better in how we approach the world, how we approach medicine, how we support each other in this process forward. You are enough. If you're feeling scared about how do you continue to grow and learn and change your practice, don't worry, do it one step at a time. You're enough. You are the solution. And I'm so thankful that we get to be on this journey together. I love the practice of medicine. I think that is what functional medicine gives clinicians such an opportunity to do, to love the practice of medicine again, to love on patients, and to get to stretch and grow and learn in our own art and science of this thing we call medicine. So I wish you incredible wellness. I wish you incredible productivity and a long time of practicing great medicine together. Thanks for being on the journey.

- You can do this. You can do this with every patient encounter. Even if you don't have the time to do a full functional medicine workup, you can use the concepts of functional medicine to help your patient improve their health. Remember, functional medicine is a thought process where we pay attention to the antecedents, triggers and mediators of what's going on with this patient. We think about their timeline. We pay attention to how all the systems in the body are interrelated and interconnected. We focus on personalizing care and we focus on those modifiable lifestyle factors. Remember, it's important to ask that question why, even if you can't always find all the reasons why this patient's body is outta balance or they have a disease, asking the question why helps you identify where you need to

focus with this patient. Remember, personalization is key. You wanna personalize your plan for the patient and really determine for that individual patient what lifestyle factors they need to modify to help them get to their optimal health. Remember, functional medicine is just good medicine.

- Well, you're to this point in the AFMCP. You are taking your training, your understanding, and you're looking through a different lens. But I'm gonna ask you to step back a second. When do you consider the miraculous? Did you see the miraculous in anything you heard today? Remember the first time you put a stethoscope on and you listened to a heartbeat, a connection to the heartbeat of someone that wasn't you? That person's heartbeats 90,000 times a day their whole life until it beats no more. Do you remember the awe of listening to that? The miraculous of ATP-ADB, flipping back and forth 300 to 1,200 times a second, kilograms a day, or the miraculous that occurs when you hear the heartbeat, the fetal heartbeat of a baby in the womb, or the miraculousness of their first cry. And you recognize everybody that you've seen in your career and your life is as unique as their fingerprint, their genomics, their exposures, the understanding of their timeline is unique to them. So then you step forward in what you've learned and you think, "Oh, do you remember when you take a fresh spice or herb and rub it between your fingers and smell it?" And can you just feel all those adaptogens, all those molecules entering your senses and actually beginning to change your physiology? This is some of the miraculous reframing that we begin to do in functional medicine. Whether you are a subspecialist or specialist, no matter what your heuristic is, whether you're a clinician, a nutritionist, however you have been trained, look through this lens and see the miraculous in the second interactions that you have with your patients, talking to them about food and how you can inspire them to, in that moment, recognize that not only are they connected to the world around them, to the food, but they are very connected to you. That is functional medicine, that is looking through this lens. Enjoy your journey.

- Hello everyone. I was asked to share a few words of my thoughts about what you are embarking on and what you've just accomplished. And it made me think back to how I felt when I had finished my first functional medicine module. And I remember being overwhelmed by how much I did not know, even though I had been practicing for many years. And it's an opportunity to lean into humility and grace and forgiveness, but also gratitude for the opportunity to be a better physician and a better clinician. You'll find that people may question what you're doing and you have to figure out how you may want to answer that question. But I can assure you that functional medicine is everywhere. It's in every practice, it's in every clinical scenario. And when we lean into the core tenets of what it is, the GOTOIT functional medicine method, identifying antecedents, triggers and mediators, thinking about our patients in relation to the functional

medicine matrix and leaning into the modifiable lifestyle factors, you will find that your patients will do much better and that you'll have a increase in your feelings of positivity about your work. As an interventional cardiologist, my biggest joy used to be doing some procedure that would improve blood flow in an artery. Now I get even more joy when a patient looks me in the eye and says, "You heard me, you listened to me. I've been to doctors for decades and this is the first time I have felt heard." I've had patients get up, walk over, and ask if they can give me a hug. That is the true joy, that is the true connection to the humanity of this work. And functional medicine ultimately is about fostering humanity and helping people be who they want to be and who they imagine they should be. So enjoy the journey, be okay with the waves of learning where the more you learn, the more you find out what you don't know, the more you learn, you find out more. And embrace that and find the joy. Thank you.

- Here is my sendoff for you. In your career, you've learned how to identify what is the matter with your patient. We invite you to go forward identifying what matters to your patient. You have learned how to identify what's wrong with your patient, and we invite you to go forward identifying what's strong with your patient. What you give of yourself to the patient is perhaps going to be the most important therapeutic intervention that you can give to your patients. You are the most important therapeutic agent. On behalf of all the educators in this course, and on behalf of the Institute for Functional Medicine and our entire staff, we'd like to thank you for engaging in this course, and we invite you to go forward and engage in a transformed way with your patients. We look forward to seeing you again in another functional medicine training. And with that, we wish you farewell.